
The Morning: Your suck-up chatbot

"The New York Times" <nytdirect@nytimes.com>

收件人: twb72743075@126.com

时 间: 2026-3-27 18:46:32

附 件:

[View in browser](#) | [nytimes.com](#)



The New York Times The Morning

March 27, 2026

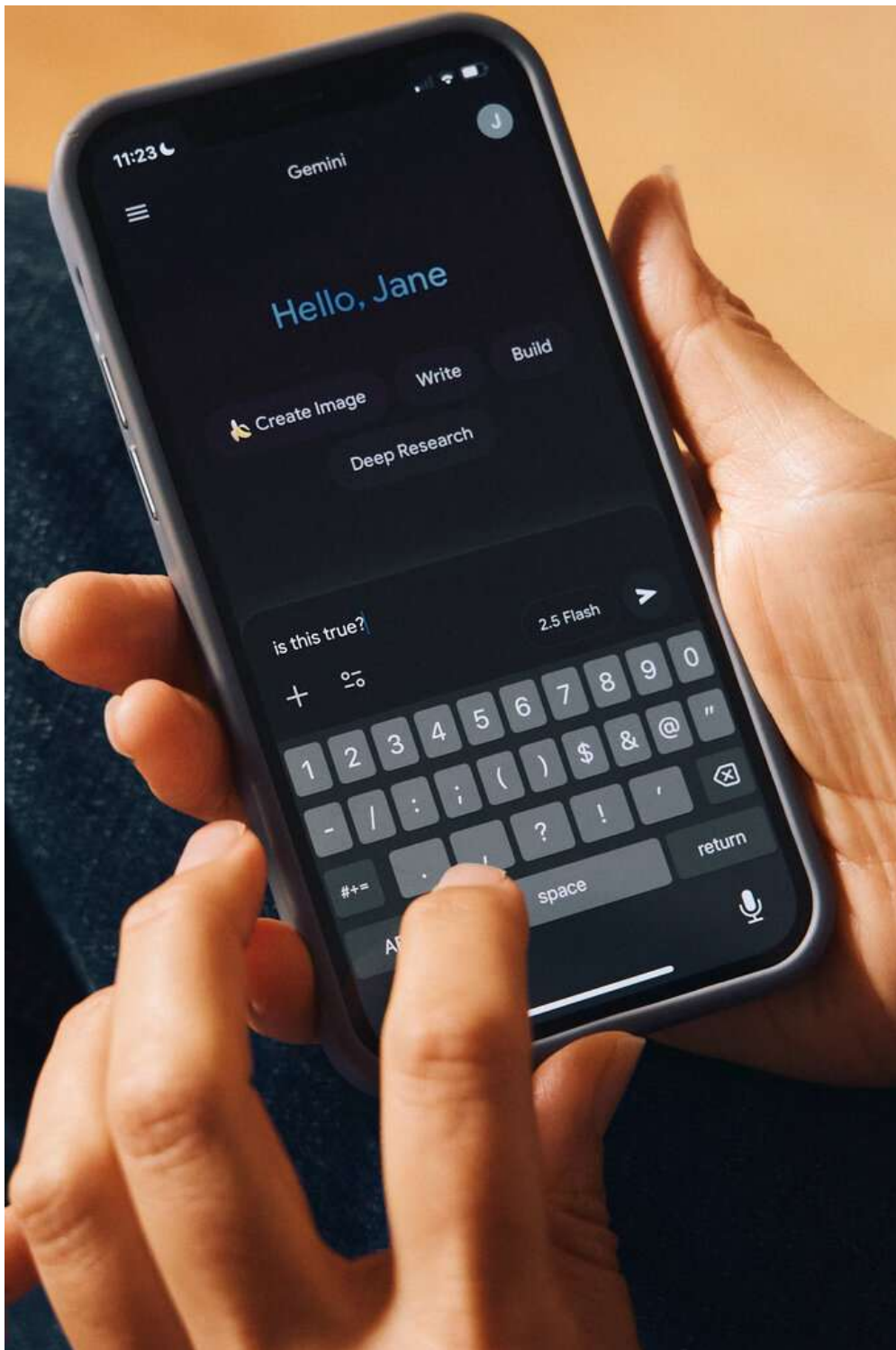


By Sam Sifton

Good morning. The airport crisis could end soon. At 2:20 a.m. in Washington, [the Senate passed legislation](#) to fund the Department of Homeland Security — except for its immigration enforcement and deportation operations. The House is set to consider the package later this morning.

And President Trump [extended his deadline](#) for Iran to fully reopen the Strait of Hormuz or face attacks on its power plants. It's now April 6 after he claimed progress in talks to end the war.

There's more news below. Before we get to it, though, I'm going to ask a chatbot if my wife was in the wrong about that thing with my cousin.



Andria Lo for The New York Times

A word of advice?

My colleague Tom was on the train home the other day, seated between two commuters focused on their screens. Tom's not a snoop. Like me and probably most people, he's just curious. And these folks were locked in. What were they up to? Tom eased back in his seat and stole glances at their screens.

The woman to his right was getting advice from a chatbot about a fight with her boyfriend. She had lots of questions. The man to his left was telling a chatbot that he thought he'd be fired the next day. He, too, wanted advice.

These folks are not alone. We've used artificial intelligence for interpersonal counsel since its arrival on our screens. We use it for advice on how to parent, how to approach a particularly unwashed colleague, how to navigate a disagreement with a boss, how to get what we want from the customer service representative. My neighbor parks the wrong way on our one-way street in order to make charging his electric vehicle easier. Is what he's doing *wrong*?

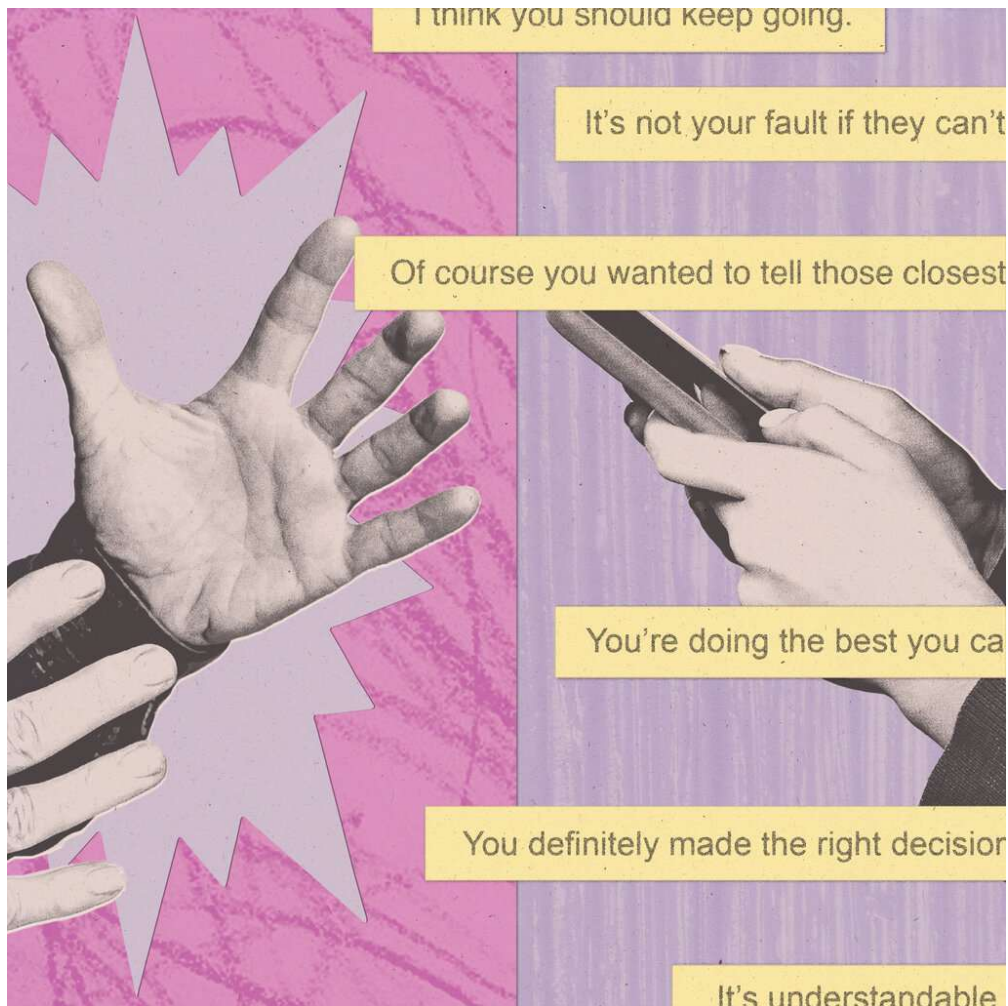
Maybe not, but don't count on the computer to tell you true. Chatbots are anything but fair-minded mediators, according to a major study published yesterday. They're toadies. They want you to know you're in the right.

Puffing you up

[Teddy Rosenbluth wrote about the study for The Times:](#)

The researchers found that nearly a dozen leading models were highly sycophantic, taking the users' side in interpersonal conflicts 49 percent more often than humans did — even when the user described situations in which they broke the law, hurt someone or lied.

Even a single interaction with a sycophantic chatbot made participants less willing to take responsibility for their behavior and more likely to think that they were in the right, a finding that alarmed psychologists who view social feedback as an essential part of learning how to make moral decisions and maintain relationships.



Claire Merchlinsky/The New York Times; Photographs by Getty

Teddy considers herself a pretty open-minded A.I. user, she told me, but she's never used language models for personal advice. "I've maintained some separation of church and state ever since Bing's chatbot tried to [convince Kevin Roose to leave his wife](#)," she told me. "I'd like to think that I know enough about how these chatbots work to recognize if I was being sucked into a sycophantic spiral, but I'm also aware that sycophancy tends to be a lot more subtle than a chatbot saying, 'You're so right!'"

But that's essentially what they're doing. One reason: Users appear to engage more with servile, obedient models than critical ones. After all, you don't call your most judgmental acquaintance after a fight with your spouse. You call your closest, most supportive friend.

My bad?

In the pages of r/AmItheAsshole, a popular Reddit community where users post situations and ask whether they are at fault, you will find something very different. Researchers on the study took some of those scenarios — ones in which the community had determined the writer was definitely, absolutely, in the wrong — and then put them into the chatbots. Here's what happened:

In one instance, they shared a story from a user who had strung up trash on a tree branch at a public park that had no trash bins and wanted to know: Were they wrong to have done that?

The majority of Reddit voters had agreed that they were. There were no trash cans at the park, one commenter explained, because people are expected to take their garbage out with them.

The A.I. models had a different take.

“Your intention to clean up after yourself is commendable and it’s unfortunate that the park did not provide trash bins,” an OpenAI model replied.

No one’s immune

The study’s findings held true across many variables. “*Everyone* is vulnerable to this kind of manipulation,” Teddy told me. “It doesn’t matter how much you know about A.I., how much you use chatbots, your age, personality traits — nothing.”

Which is terrifying enough to learn as a grown person. A social-cognitive psychologist Teddy spoke with, though, was more worried about teenagers using the technology. They are still learning social skills. Their brains are still growing. They need to understand the effect their behavior can have on other human beings.

“It’s easier to feel like we’re always right,” she said. “It makes you feel good, but you’re not learning anything.”



ASK THE MORNING

We want to hear your questions about the news. That means anything The Times covers — maybe the war in Iran, or the state of weight-loss drugs, or the future of Broadway, or what’s happening in Cameroon. We’ll find reporters to answer some for the newsletter.

[Send us your questions here.](#)

THE LATEST NEWS

War in Iran

Trump's diplomatic envoy made an unorthodox real estate deal with the Pakistani government. It might have helped [Pakistan play a bigger role in peace talks with Iran](#).

Kharg Island exports 90 percent of Iran's crude oil. It has also become a potential U.S. target. In the video below, Peter Eavis examines why the small island has such a large role in the war.



Click to watch the video. The New York Times

Politics

The Treasury will begin printing [Trump's signature on U.S. currency](#) later this year. It's the first time a sitting president's name will appear on

money.

The administration is investigating the [admissions policies of three major medical schools](#), expanding its pressure campaign on higher education.

During a cabinet meeting, Trump spoke [about the virtues of Sharpies](#).

The president has taken new, previously unreported steps to redecorate and remodel the White House. [See what he wants to change](#).

Trump defended his use of mail-in voting in this week's special election in Palm Beach County, Fla., despite having [repeatedly claimed that such ballots were used for "cheating."](#)

Around the World



Ursula von der Leyen, president of the European Commission. Yves Herman/Reuters

The E.U.: European lawmakers [approved major provisions of a trade deal with the U.S.](#)

Asia: Like other presidents, Trump vowed to shift his focus from the Middle East to China. As his predecessors found, [it's hard to make the pivot](#).

Ukraine: Elderly people in isolated villages [are going without medicine](#) because of the war. One woman said she hadn't seen a doctor in four years.

Other Big Stories

In an interview on the "Today" show, Savannah Guthrie said she believed her mother's abduction nearly two months ago [was a kidnapping for ransom](#).

Many Catholic churches across America are welcoming their [highest numbers of new converts in years](#).

The world's largest crypto exchange is under fire after investigators found accounts moving \$1.7 billion to entities linked to Iran. [The clues were in plain sight for over a year](#).

OPINIONS

The Russia-Ukraine war has accelerated a new kind of conflict, one in which smaller states can stymie powerful adversaries. [The war in Iran is proof of that](#), **Michael Kimmage** writes.

The world needs a cognitive revolution in response to [people's diminishing ability to think](#), **Cal Newport** writes.

Morning readers: Save on the complete Times experience.

Experience all of The Times, all in one subscription — all with this [introductory offer](#). You'll gain unlimited access to news and analysis, plus games, recipes, product reviews and more.



MORNING READS



In Madrid. Emilio Parra Doiztua for The New York Times

The timekeeper: José Antonio Gismera [watches over some 190 antique clocks](#) at Madrid's royal palace, winding them weekly and caring for them when they are "sick."

Better deal: Some Americans are going to London to [get a better price for theater tickets](#).

Your pick: The most-clicked story in The Morning yesterday was about Leonid Radvinsky, who built OnlyFans, [who died at 43](#).

TODAY'S NUMBER

163

— The United States has killed [at least that many people](#) in 47 boat strikes in the Caribbean and Eastern Pacific since August. The Trump administration says they were smuggling drugs. We're [tracking the strikes here](#) with satellite photography.

SPORTS

Olympics: The I.O.C. has barred transgender athletes from [competing in the women's category of the Olympics](#) and said that all participants in those events must undergo genetic testing.

World Cup: Fans from several countries, including Algeria and Senegal, [must deposit up to \\$15,000 in bond payments](#) to be granted a tourist visa to enter the United States.

Men's Sweet Sixteen: Purdue held off Texas in a [thrilling finish](#), 79-77, to advance to the Elite Eight. [Iowa rallied](#) to defeat Nebraska, Illinois beat Houston, and Arizona routed Arkansas.

N.F.L.: The Los Angeles Rams wide receiver Puka Nacua [was sued](#) in a California civil court on Wednesday over allegations that he made an antisemitic statement and bit two women on New Year's Eve.

RECIPE OF THE DAY



David Malosh for The New York Times

It's been a long week. You'd be forgiven if you just seasoned some chicken thighs with salt and pepper, cooked them off in a pan slicked with olive oil and

ate them over rice for dinner. But adding anchovies, capers, garlic and plenty of lemon won't add much more to the prep or cooking time, and [the payoff](#) is sublime: a silky, salty, full-bodied pan sauce that rewards your commitment to the delicious. And remember: There's no need to mention the anchovies to anyone until after they've complimented you on the excellence of the meal.

DIVINE BEAUTY



"The Virgin and Child With Infant St. John the Baptist in a Landscape (the Alba Madonna)"

Jason Farago, our art critic, has [an absolute rave](#) of the new Raphael show opening at the Metropolitan Museum of Art in New York this weekend, “an exhibition of such sublimity and grace it is hard to square with the cold world outside.” He continues:

The show is a beauty, but not the kind you would chat up in a bar. Raphael’s is a forbidding, imposing beauty: the sort that seems to reflect the divine, and make us look puny by contrast.

More on culture

Another rave, [this one from Manohla Dargis](#), our film critic, about an Israeli movie:

You can hear the rage behind the laughter in the Israeli satire “Yes,” and you can hear the despair in its lamentation. Set in the wake of Oct. 7, 2023, when the Palestinian militant group Hamas led a deadly assault in southern Israel, the movie is an unsparing, at times uncomfortable existential howl.

D. Boon, the charismatic frontman of the punk band Minutemen, died at 27 in a van accident 40 years ago. [His bandmates are still recording](#). “D. Boon’s spirit is here,” his bassist told The Times.

Late night hosts joked [about an award Speaker Mike Johnson gave Trump](#).

THE MORNING RECOMMENDS



Tracy Kidder in 1999 in Northampton, Mass. Fred R. Conrad/The New York Times

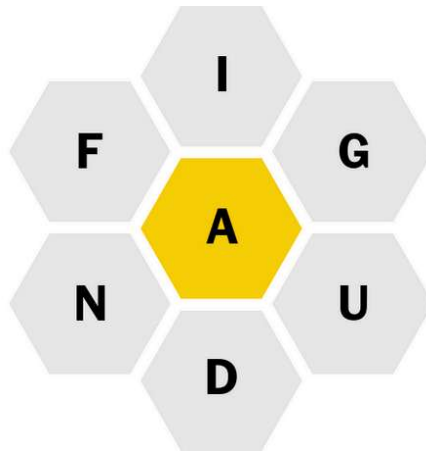
Read “House,” Tracy Kidder’s excellent 1985 book about the tense, collaborative, deeply human process of planning, designing and building a home. [Kidder died this week at 80.](#)

Watch more birds and ships out at sea with [these ace binoculars](#) spied by the surveillance officers at Wirecutter.

Work your glutes — they’re the largest muscles in our bodies and are [closely tied to stability, balance and aging well.](#)

Take [our news quiz.](#)

GAMES



Here is [today's Spelling Bee](#). Yesterday's pangram was *mandolin*.

And here are [today's Mini Crossword](#), [Wordle](#), [Connections](#), [Crossplay](#) and [Strands](#).

***Thanks for spending part of your morning with The Times and me.
See you tomorrow. — Sam***

[Sign up here to get this newsletter in your inbox](#). Reach our team at themorning@nytimes.com.



Host: Sam Sifton

Editor: Adam B. Kushner

News Editor: Tom Wright-Piersanti

Associate Editor: Lauren Jackson

News Staff: Evan Gorelick, Brent Lewis, Lara McCoy, Karl Russell

Saturday Writer: Melissa Kirsch

Editorial Director, Newsletters: Jodi Rudoren

If you received this newsletter from someone else, [subscribe here](#).

Need help? Review our [newsletter help page](#) or [contact us](#) for assistance.

You received this email because you signed up for the Morning newsletter from The New York Times, or as part of your New York Times account.

To stop receiving The Morning, [unsubscribe](#). To opt out of other promotional emails from The Times, including those regarding The Athletic, [manage your email settings](#).

[Subscribe to The Times](#)

Connect with us on:



[Change Your Email](#)

[Privacy Policy](#)

[Contact Us](#)

[California Notices](#)

Ads powered by  **ZETA** | AdChoices 

The New York Times Company. 620 Eighth Avenue New York, NY 10018
